

# Launch + ICN — Formation-to-Governance Discovery

THURSDAY 2026-05-21 · 10:30–11:30 AM ET · 60 MINUTES

Visual notes page. Use to keep the conversation on the seam: formation workflow → durable institutional memory.

## FRAME

|       |                                                                                                                                                                          |      |                                                                                                         |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FRAME | Launch helps cooperatives come into being. ICN is the question of what helps cooperatives continue governing, remembering, coordinating, and federating after formation. | GOAL | Test whether that seam exists — and, if so, where patronage and capital account history sits inside it. |
| TALK  | 1–2 min per beat, then listen 5+ min.                                                                                                                                    | WIN  | One smallest sanitized rehearsal target — or a clear "not useful yet."                                  |

## WHAT LAUNCH APPEARS TO FOCUS ON

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
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| LAUNCH CONTEXT (FROM PUBLIC MATERIAL)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Guided onboarding / decision-tree framing for co-op formation</li><li>• Teams, co-founders, task assignment, comments on steps</li><li>• Documents, change history, secure document portal</li><li>• Advisors / TA providers / lawyers / CPAs / co-op networks</li><li>• Mobile, print, multilingual access (English + Spanish, expandable)</li><li>• Reducing TA bottlenecks <i>without</i> replacing TA providers</li><li>• Framing: "make the ask feel doable."</li></ul> |

## THE INSTITUTIONAL SPINE



Eight words. Introduce in one breath. Ask whether the order matches how formation work actually moves into ongoing governance.

## LAUNCH TRANSLATION OF THE SPINE

| LAUNCH SURFACE                                    | ICN SUBSTRATE QUESTION                             |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Founding team / co-founders                       | Who has standing?                                  |
| Roles / advisor relationship                      | Who can act, review, guide, or certify?            |
| Formation path selected                           | What process is this group actually in?            |
| Governance doc drafted                            | What artifact exists, and under whose authority?   |
| Task assigned                                     | Who owes what by when?                             |
| Service provider engaged                          | What obligation exists across the boundary?        |
| Milestone completed                               | What effect happened?                              |
| Approval / confirmation                           | What receipt exists?                               |
| Document / change history                         | What evidence survives?                            |
| Launch → operating co-op handoff                  | What standing / authority carries forward?         |
| Patronage / internal capital / accounting records | What is governance evidence vs. accounting record? |

## 60-SECOND OPENER

From what I understand, Launch is trying to make co-op formation less like wandering through a legal, financial, and governance junk drawer with a flashlight dying in your mouth.

You are breaking the process into steps people can actually move through: teams, documents, tasks, advisors, service providers, and milestones.

ICN is coming at the next layer: once those steps become real institutional facts, how does the co-op remember them? Who has standing? Who was authorized? What decision happened? What obligation followed? What evidence survives when the advisor, organizer, or founding team rotates out?

I want to understand whether there is a clean seam between Launch's formation workflow and the layer ICN is working on — or whether that seam does not exist yet.

## PRIMARY WALKTHROUGH — FORMATION → DURABLE GOVERNANCE HANDOFF

Walk one beat at a time. After each beat ask: *How does this happen today? What state needs to persist? Who needs to trust it later? Where would a receipt help, and where would it become bureaucracy?*

1

### Group enters Launch onboarding

**TODAY** Decision-tree intake / wizard.

**ICN** First institutional record that this group exists and is forming?

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2

### Founding team / co-founders identified

**TODAY** Roster inside Launch.

**ICN** When do these people gain standing — and what kind?

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3

### Roles & advisor / TA / provider relationships established

**TODAY** Relationship records in Launch.

**ICN** Who can act with what authority, on whose behalf, with what professional scope?

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4

### Formation path selected

**TODAY** Co-op model / legal entity track chosen.

**ICN** What process is this group in, and what authority does that selection carry?

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5

### Governance documents drafted

**TODAY** Drafts in document portal.

**ICN** Under whose authority, and what receipt when adopted?

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6

### Tasks assigned to co-founders / advisors / providers

**TODAY** Task surface in Launch.

**ICN** Each task is an obligation — by whom, to whom, owed by when, completed by what evidence?

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### **Legal / accounting / co-op-developer service provider loop triggered**

**TODAY** Vendor / advisor engagement, often outside Launch.

**ICN** What crosses the boundary, what comes back, what record proves both?

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8

### **Decision or milestone completed**

**TODAY** Checked box / signed doc / meeting minute.

**ICN** What effect did it have, against what authority, with what receipt?

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9

### **Member standing / board authority / operating roles established**

**TODAY** The moment Launch hands off to "the co-op exists now."

**ICN** What carries forward — and what is silently dropped?

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10

### **Economic participation / patronage / allocation records become relevant**

**TODAY** Usually CPA / bookkeeper territory.

**ICN** Where does governance evidence meet accounting record? See economic branch below.

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11

### **Handoff into durable institutional memory / ongoing governance**

**TODAY** Fuzzy moment where Launch's role recedes.

**ICN** What record survives the handoff that next year's board, a funder, a regulator, or a future member can verify?

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## BRANCHES

### PATRONAGE AND CAPITAL ACCOUNT HISTORY

- The records McKenzie surfaced on May 1
- Institutional memory, not accounting software
- Boundary between governance evidence and CPA-owned record
- What ICN should never touch here

*Inquiry only. ICN is not an accounting system, bank, payment app, wallet, or money transmitter.*

### ADVISOR / SERVICE PROVIDER

- What lawyers / CPAs / bookkeepers / TA providers need to see
- What they can attest to
- What stays under their professional authority
- Cross-boundary obligation records

## QUESTIONS TO ASK

### ON LAUNCH'S WORKFLOW

Q Where does a formation workflow lose institutional memory?

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Q What records matter after the co-op is formed?

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Q Where do teams / tasks / docs / advisor notes need continuity?

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Q What milestones are legally / accounting- / governance-meaningful?

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### ON STANDING / AUTHORITY

Q When does someone become a member / founder / board actor / officer / advisor?

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Q *Who can authorize a document, filing, provider engagement, or milestone?*

#### ON ADVISORS / SERVICE PROVIDERS

Q *What do lawyers, CPAs, bookkeepers, TA providers, or co-op developers need to see and attest to?*

Q *What must remain under professional authority, not ICN's?*

#### ON PATRONAGE AND CAPITAL ACCOUNT HISTORY

Q *Which of your co-op projects needed a patronage or capital account record that didn't exist or didn't survive? What broke?*

Q *Where do those records first enter a formation workflow? Who needs to trust them later — members, fiscal sponsor, attorney, future board?*

Q *What is governance evidence vs. accounting record vs. professional execution? What should ICN never touch?*

#### ON ANTI-SOFTWARE BOUNDARIES & NEXT STEP

Q *What must stay human / process-first? What should expire? Never be public? Need explicit consent?*

Q *Smallest fictional / sanitized formation-to-governance rehearsal worth doing? Who else should be in that room?*

**When critique lands, do not defend.** Capture the objection. Translate it into a design question. Ask

what would make the thing safer or more useful. The meeting's value is calibration, not persuasion.

### CLAIMS NOT TO MAKE

- Still pre-pilot. Not production-ready, not externally audited, not legally / regulatorily certified.
- Not a live federation. Not an end-to-end federation lifecycle.
- Not replacing Launch, TA providers, lawyers, CPAs, bookkeepers, or co-op developers.
- Not accounting software. Not payment / banking / wallet software.
- Receipts alone do not prove legitimacy. Authority shortcuts must label themselves.
- Vocabulary: **settlement, obligation, allocation, unit, position, receipt, provenance, evidence.** Avoid the forbidden financial / crypto vocabulary listed in the Thursday brief.
- Community-infra (Matrix / n8n / bridge / etc.) is a separate workstream — do not mention unless asked.
- No real Launch, NYCN, or private partner data has been or will be put in git.

### AFTER THE MEETING — CAPTURE

**REAL / USEFUL**

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**WRONG / OVERBUILT / UNCLEAR**

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**CLEAN SEAM IDENTIFIED (FORMATION → GOVERNANCE)**

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**SEAM REJECTED / NOT READY**

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**SMALLEST REHEARSAL CANDIDATE**

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**ECONOMIC / PATRONAGE / ACCOUNTING QUESTIONS**

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**WHO ELSE SHOULD JOIN**

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**FOLLOW-UP ACTION / CADENCE**

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Status: descriptive · Canonical: no · Last reviewed 2026-05-18 · No private partner / NYCN data. Companion to docs/strategy/COOPERATIVE\_FORMATION\_PLATFORM\_MEETING\_PREP\_2026-05-21.md and docs/strategy/COOPERATIVE\_FORMATION\_PLATFORM\_ONE\_PAGE\_AID\_2026-05-21.md.